GRID WIRE

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Grid Wire — Week of June 15, 2026

Texas energy & AI-infrastructure intelligence. Window: June 8–15, 2026, with clearly-flagged early-June context. Updated through 22:53 UTC, June 15. Every item traces to a dated primary or first-tier source; widely-circulated stories that failed date-checking are excluded.

The Lede — Texas stops courting AI load and starts pricing it

Two actions eight days apart redefined the Texas large-load market. On **June 1–2** the ERCOT board endorsed **"Batch Zero"** (PGRR145 / NPRR1325) — the transitional framework that moves data-center interconnection from one-at-a-time studies to batch allocation of transmission headroom, with queue priority tied to demonstrated flexibility and a qualification/security fee reported in the **$50,000–$100,000/MW** range. On **June 10**, Governor Abbott ordered the PUC and ERCOT to ensure new data centers **fully fund their own grid infrastructure** and that interconnections lower residential bills — with hard deadlines (joint memo **July 17**, PUC action to cut residential transmission costs **July 31**) and a promise of next-session legislation to repeal the data-center sales-tax exemption and mandate closed-loop cooling.

The throughline: the buildout pipeline is now so large — roughly **438 GW** of large-load requests, >5× the all-time system peak, ~90% data centers — that the marginal policy question has flipped from "how much load can we attract" to "who pays, and on what terms." Cost-causation, mandatory curtailability (75 MW+ loads now legally interruptible), and bring-your-own-generation are hardening from talking points into rules. For anyone underwriting a Texas interconnection, land position, or counterparty, the value now sits with **flexible, self-funded, generation-paired** load — and against speculative grid-only requests.

Capital markets did not wait for the rules: **June 9–11 alone** saw an investment-grade Texas data-center bond (**Hut 8, $4.25B**), a **$35B** chip-backed Apollo/Broadcom/Anthropic facility, and **$3.5B** of CoreWeave notes price at a ~9.6% USD coupon. Morgan Stanley now sees **~$570B** of AI-related debt issuance in 2026, roughly double 2025 — and on **June 15, Nvidia itself** priced a **$25B** investment-grade bond, its largest ever and first since 2021, putting the dominant GPU vendor squarely inside the debt wave it supplies.

By the Numbers

Figure	What	Source
438 GW	ERCOT large-load interconnection requests (early 2026); ~200 data centers / large users. Firmer figure was ~226 GW Nov 2025 — headline is inflated by speculative/duplicate filings.	ERCOT via Houston Public Media
~100 GW	Load volume Batch Zero is designed to study in batches	RTO Insider
92.2 GW	ERCOT summer-2026 peak-demand forecast (92,211 MW) vs. **85.5 GW** record (Aug 10, 2023). EEA probability **0.09% June / 0.21% July**.	KERA / Community Impact
$50–100k/ MW	Reported large-load qualification / financial-security fee (Batch Zero + SB6 §25.194)	RTO Insider; Greenberg Traurig
$4.25B	Hut 8 Beacon Point IG bond, 6.129%, Baa2/BBB−, 352 MW campus in Nueces County, TX	PR Newswire
$35B	Apollo/Blackstone capital solution for Broadcom "XPV Platform" / Anthropic (>1 GW → 20+ GW)	Apollo IR; Axios
~$570B	Morgan Stanley forecast: 2026 AI-related global debt issuance (~2× 2025)	Reuters via Tech Startups
$25B	Nvidia IG bond priced **June 15** — largest in its history, first since 2021; 7 tranches (2028–2056), 4.25–5.625%, T+20–65bp; Aa1/AA−	SEC pricing term sheet
$25B (+~$40B)	Japan pledge to NuScale + US SMR supply chain; separate ~$40B to GE Vernova-Hitachi BWRX-300	SEDaily; FPJ
$411M	7th Texas Energy Fund In-ERCOT loan — Rayburn Electric, 570 MW gas, Sherman, COD 2028	Office of the Governor
$350M	Texas TANEO advanced-nuclear grants; first awards expected ~July 2026	Utility Dive

ERCOT & the Texas Grid

Batch Zero clears the ERCOT board; PUC vote is the next gate (not yet done). The board endorsed the transitional large-load rules June 1–2; they go to the PUC for approval at its **June 18** open meeting, target effective **July 10**. The package adds a **Provisional Controllable Load Resource (PCLR)** pathway letting loads energize early under SCED curtailment while transmission upgrades are built. CEO Pablo Vegas pitched the ~100 GW framework as a template other RTOs could adopt. Read: this is the machinery that converts a 438 GW paper queue into studied, committed load — and it explicitly rewards curtailable, flexible demand. Source: RTO Insider · Houston Public Media

Summer 2026 outlook: adequate, but the record-peak math is live. ERCOT's operational weather outlook leans near-normal and is explicitly "not forecasting another record-breaking summer," while the load forecast still carries a potential peak above **92 GW** vs. the 85.5 GW record. EEA (emergency) probability is pegged at **0.09% in June, 0.21% in July**. Recent supply adds cited: ~5 GW battery, ~4 GW solar, ~1.5 GW gas. This is also the **first summer under RTC+B** (real-time co-optimization + batteries, live since Dec 5, 2025) — the first hot-weather read on the new ancillary-services construct (ASDCs replaced the ORDC). Source: KERA · Community Impact

Texas Energy Fund keeps disbursing — 7th In-ERCOT loan to a co-op. The PUC finalized a 20-year, 3%, up-to-**$411M** TEF loan (≈60% of a sub-$685M cost) to **Rayburn Electric Cooperative** for a **570 MW** gas plant near Sherman (ERCOT North), COD 2028 — the seventh finalized In-ERCOT loan and a signal that cooperatives, not just IPPs, are landing dispatchable-gen capital. Separately, the PUC executed its **third Completion Bonus Grant** (May 28) with **Calpine** — up to $55.2M for the 460 MW Pin Oak Creek peaker (Freestone County). Note the program clock: last day for initial disbursements on approved In-ERCOT loans is **Dec 31, 2026**. Source: Office of the Governor · Calpine

Transmission: ~$6.5B of projects cleared TAC; the 765 kV backbone advances. ERCOT's Technical Advisory Committee endorsed roughly **$6.5B** in transmission projects on May 19. The state's first 765 kV extra-high-voltage backbone (Oncor/AEP Western Loop, multi-utility Eastern Loop) continues through the RPG/CCN pipeline; the Permian Basin Reliability Plan's three 765 kV import paths were approved April 2025, with AEP Texas building one of the first lines. Watch CCN actions as the Abbott cost-shift directive reshapes who pays for these upgrades. Source: Texas Energy & Power · RTO Insider

Structural backdrop: solar overtakes coal; storage near 14 GW. ERCOT solar generation surpassed coal for the first time in March 2026 and is forecast to stay above it through year-end. Texas entered 2026 with **~13.9 GW of battery capacity** (nearly double a year earlier), and ERCOT expects **15–20 GW of new resources** in 2026, heavily solar + storage. Source: U.S. EIA · Modo Energy

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Data Centers & Large Load

The macro map (best single reference this week). The Texas Tribune's June 8 survey counts **≥248 planned data centers** and **519 ERCOT connection requests** over two years (vs. 24 the prior year), ~**438,595 MW** requested (~90% data centers); regional split 86 North Texas / 56 Central / 45 West; max planned single site ~10,800 MW. New facilities need ~5× the capacity of existing Texas data centers, and water use could reach **3–9% of statewide demand by 2040** (from <1% today). Notably, ERCOT is not assessing whether enough electricity exists — supply is assumed market-driven. Source: Texas Tribune

The co-located template: Google/Intersect break ground on the Meitner Energy Center (Panhandle). On June 4, Google and newly-acquired Intersect Power broke ground in Gray/Roberts Counties: four data-center buildings drawing up to **840 MW**, paired on-site with **>1 GW** of wind/solar/battery plus gas backup and ~3 GWh storage — generation and load permitted as one complex. Part of Google's ~$40B Texas push through 2027. This is the cleanest "generation-first" campus model now setting the Texas template — exactly the structure Batch Zero rewards. Source: POWER Magazine · DCD

Supply side: NRG commissions its first new plant in a decade. On June 11 NRG brought online the **456 MW** TH Wharton gas peaker near Houston, financed via a Texas Energy Fund loan — units start in ~30 minutes on ERCOT call. Not data-center-dedicated, but it is the supply answer to the same demand curve and validates TEF as a working fast-start-gas channel. Source: Axios Houston · NRG IR

The rural-county revolt is now the siting risk. A June 2 deep-dive on **Hood County** captures the statewide friction: eight proposed projects across 7,600+ acres — led by Sailfish Investors' **Comanche Circle** (~3 GW across three projects, 2,100 acres, $5–20B tax-base potential) and **Pacifico Energy's Fort Spunky** (100 MW, 862 acres). Texas counties lack zoning authority; two moratorium votes failed, Pacifico sued the county for $250k+ over a revoked concept plan, and Sen. Bettencourt warned the AG against county moratoriums. Directly relevant to LRP's Pacifico/GW Ranch counterparty work — the same developer, the same playbook, now litigating local control. Source: Texas Tribune · Texas Observer

Curtailability is now law, not courtesy. Texas statute requires new loads of **75 MW+** interconnecting from 2026 onward to accept **mandatory curtailment** during firm load-shed events. Combined with Batch Zero's flexibility incentives, interruptibility is now hard-coded into the Texas large-load value proposition — central to how ERCOT plans to absorb hundreds of GW without proportional firm capacity. Source: Texas Tribune

Standing context (not a new event): the Abilene flagship is not growing past 1.2 GW. Crusoe/Oracle's 1.2 GW Stargate I continues completing buildings on GB200 racks, but the 600 MW expansion to ~2.0 GW **remains canceled** (financing + OpenAI demand re-forecast, originally March 2026); the Nvidia ~$150M deposit and Meta-takes-the-lease talk are unresolved. For the LRP Stargate diligence file: the answer to "does Abilene grow" is still no. Source: DCD

Capital & Financing — an unusually heavy debt week

The marquee print (June 15): Nvidia itself sells $25B of investment-grade debt. Nvidia priced a **$25B** seven-tranche senior unsecured bond — upsized intraday from ~$20B at launch — its **largest ever and first since 2021** (settles June 18; Goldman / J.P. Morgan / Morgan Stanley books; **Moody's Aa1 / S&P AA−**, existing issuer ratings, not a new action). Despite a large cash balance and an $80B buyback, the dominant GPU vendor is now issuing into the same AI-infra debt wave it supplies — the cleanest expression yet of the circular-financing / capex-intensity debate, and a live marker on Morgan Stanley's ~$570B-for-2026 call.

Tranche	Size	Spread	Yield
4.250% 2028	$3.5B	T+20	4.273%
4.350% 2029	$3.5B	T+25	4.367%
4.500% 2031	$4.0B	T+35	4.543%
4.750% 2033	$3.5B	T+45	4.776%
4.950% 2036	$4.0B	T+50	4.973%
5.550% 2046	$3.0B	T+60	5.581%
5.625% 2056	$3.5B	T+65	5.628%

Source: SEC FWP pricing term sheet · Bloomberg

Hut 8 closes the first Baa2 data-center project bond — and it's in Texas. June 9: Beacon Point DC LLC closed **$4.25B** of 6.129% senior secured notes due 2042 (fully amortizing from 2030), priced at **T+165bp** — 20bp inside Hut 8's April deal — rated **Baa2/BBB−/BBB−**, non-recourse to parent. Funds a 352 MW, six-hall campus on ~521 acres in **Nueces County, TX**, pre-leased to an undisclosed AA−-or-higher tenant. J.P. Morgan lead. The investment-grade notch, on a Texas asset, is the read-through: project-level DC debt is maturing into the IG market. Source: PR Newswire

The structural deal of the week: Apollo's $35B chip-backed facility for Broadcom/Anthropic. June 9: Apollo and Blackstone anchor a **$35B** financing for Broadcom's "XPV Platform," initially funding >1 GW of compute for Anthropic and scaling toward 20+ GW through 2028. Reporting describes a chip/lease-backed SPV with Google backstopping lease payments at Fluidstack-operated sites (TeraWulf, Cipher, Hut 8 as operators). No coupon disclosed. Vendor + hyperscaler credit support layered into private-credit — the template for how the next leg gets funded. Source: Apollo IR · Axios

CoreWeave prints $3.5B — and the coupon tells you where neocloud credit sits. Priced June 11: **$1.25B at 9.625%** (USD) + **€2.0B at 8.500%**, both due 2032, unsecured. Against >$17.3B total debt, ~10.7× debt/equity, and a $4.2B principal repayment due later in 2026, a ~9.6% unsecured coupon is the market's price on neocloud risk. Source: BusinessWire

The aggregate: ~$570B of AI debt in 2026. Morgan Stanley (June 10) sees 2026 AI-related global debt issuance near **$570B**, ~4× the year-earlier pace through May, against ~$700B of 2026 hyperscaler capex (projected >$1T in 2027), with issuers pushing into non-USD markets. Source: Reuters via Tech Startups

Supply chain + converts. Super Micro (June 9) launched **$7.0B** of equity/equity-linked financing to fund ~$39B of booked AI-server orders — and shares fell ~20% intraday on the dilution. Keel Infrastructure (June 9) closed **$458M** of **1.250%** convertible notes due 2032 (~25% conversion premium) to fund long-lead equipment for its data-center pipeline — a reminder that converts let developers raise cheap capital against equity upside. Source: Supermicro · DCD

The credit watch-items. SoftBank (June 4) is shopping a margin loan **collateralized by its OpenAI stake —** lenders balk because the shares lack a continuous price; SoftBank CDS reportedly ~360bp, with a recent 10-yr tranche at an 8.5% coupon. Oracle reported record Q4/FY26 (June 10) on ~$50B FY26 capex guidance, but its CDS sits near post-2009 highs (>125bp) on the OpenAI-concentration story. And the swing variable under all the GPU-backed paper is **residual value**: Blackwell B300 lead times are compressing (~36→18 weeks) into the Rubin transition, pressuring rental rates and ABS depreciation assumptions (rating frameworks now stress ~50% value at yr 3, ~10–20% at yr 5). Source: Benzinga · Techi

Advanced Nuclear

The financing wave is the story: Japan commits ~$25B to NuScale + US SMR supply chain. June 12–13: Japan is in final talks to commit up to **$25B** to NuScale and a US SMR supply chain, framed around AI/data-center load — alongside a separate ~**$40B** commitment to GE Vernova-Hitachi's **BWRX-300** program (Tennessee/Alabama, ~3 GW), pushing cumulative Japanese US-nuclear investment toward ~$65B. It's a supply-chain/financing pledge, not contracted offtake — conversion-to-revenue is the watch item. Market read-through: nuclear equities rallied hard on June 15 on the reports — NuScale, Oklo and X-energy among the movers (intraday gains high-single to double digits, per market trackers). Source: SEDaily · Foreign Policy Journal

Oklo clears a DOE safety gate and integrates manufacturing. June 11: DOE approved the **Preliminary Documented Safety Analysis** for Oklo's first Aurora powerhouse at INL — a key step on the Reactor Pilot Program pathway toward construction while NRC commercial licensing runs in parallel. Days earlier (announced June 8, closed June 4) Oklo **acquired ARMEC**, an Oak Ridge precision-manufacturing shop, to bring fabrication in-house across its reactor and fuel programs. Source: World Nuclear News · BusinessWire

Europe's order book moves: Sweden picks Rolls-Royce SMR. June 15: Videberg Kraft (Vattenfall + Industrikraft, state to become majority owner) selected the **Rolls-Royce SMR** (470 MWe PWR) over the BWRX-300 for **three units (~1.5 GW)** near Ringhals, first unit mid-2030s — Sweden the third European country to choose RR SMR. Separately, **Studsvik** (June 12) sought state support for up to **1,400 MW** of LWR SMRs at two sites. Source: World Nuclear News — Sweden/RR · WNN — Studsvik

The Texas thread is anticipatory — TANEO awards are the catalyst. Texas's **$350M** Advanced Nuclear Energy Office grant program (HB 14) closed applications May 14; **first recipients are expected ~July 2026** (eligibility requires a docketed NRC construction-permit/license application or reasonable expectation by Dec 1, 2026). The freshest Texas-adjacent developer news is **X-energy** entering the UK Generic Design Assessment for its Xe-100 (June 2) — the same reactor behind the **Dow Seadrift, TX** cogeneration project (Amazon offtake up to 5 GW by 2039). And the national read-through for Texas's pilot reactors (Last Energy at A&M-RELLIS; Natura MSR-1 at ACU) racing the **July 4 DOE criticality goal**: Antares' Mark-0 became the **first reactor critical under the DOE Pilot Program** on June 4. Source: Utility Dive — TANEO · WNN — X-energy · POWER — Antares

Policy & Regulation

Texas

Abbott's cost-shift directive is the week's most market-moving Texas signal. June 10: the Governor directed the PUC to require data centers to **fully fund** their serving infrastructure so costs don't fall on residential ratepayers — joint PUC/ERCOT memo due **July 17**, PUC action to reduce residential transmission costs due **July 31** — and pledged legislation to repeal data-center sales-tax exemptions, mandate water-efficient cooling, and require usage reporting. It pressures the pending SB6 rule toward the strict end and puts the tax exemption explicitly on the table — load-side underwriting and siting economics both move. Source: Office of the Governor · RTO Insider

SB6 large-load rule (§25.194) is pending, not adopted. Proposed March 12, comments closed April 17; adoption expected later in 2026 (statutory deadline Dec 31). The draft governs loads ≥75 MW with non-refundable fees (reported $50–100k/MW in some scenarios), financial security with forfeiture for delay/withdrawal, site-control proof, and affiliate/parallel-project disclosure. A parallel transmission cost-allocation proceeding (Project 58484) is moving toward replacing 4CP and eliminating large-load interconnection cost allowances. Source: Greenberg Traurig · DLA Piper

Federal

Court restores the 5% safe harbor weeks before the July 4 cliff. June 6: a D.C. district court vacated IRS Notice 2025-42 (which had killed the 5% begin-construction safe harbor for wind and solar >1.5 MW under §§45Y/48E), finding the IRS acted arbitrarily under the APA. Effect: the **5% safe harbor is restored** (subject to appeal/revised guidance) **less than a month before the July 4, 2026 OBBBA begin-construction deadline** to preserve full-value credits — materially de-risking late-stage wind/solar racing the cliff, including ERCOT's heavy solar/storage pipeline. Source: Holland & Knight

FERC's national large-load order is imminent (committed by end of June — not yet out). Following its April 16 "intent to act," FERC committed to issue an order in the **RM26-4** large-load docket **by end of June 2026** — potentially touching jurisdiction, interconnection process, co-located load/generation treatment, and cost allocation. Watch for it at/around the **June 18** open meeting; it sets the national template that interacts with ERCOT's intrastate approach. Source: FERC · Holland & Knight

Section 232 tariff reset took effect June 8. A June 1 White House proclamation restructured metals tariffs effective **June 8** through Dec 31, 2027: 25% baseline on most steel/aluminum/copper, a reduced **15%** rate for certain industrial machinery, and goods with ≤15% metal content exiting 232 entirely. Importers of transformers, switchgear, and grid equipment must re-map exposure — direct capex and lead-time implications for ERCOT transmission build-out and generator interconnection. (Treat transformer-specific rates as directional pending line-item confirmation.) Source: C.H. Robinson

DOE "Speed to Power" 202(c) orders keep plants online; expirations land this window. Active emergency orders (Schahfer & F.B. Culley, IN; Craig Unit 1, CO) run through **June 21 / June 28**; the Campbell (MI) coal-delay order is being litigated on authority grounds. No new Texas/ERCOT 202(c) order this week, but the litigation outcome shapes whether DOE keeps delaying thermal retirements — a precedent ERCOT-adjacent owners are watching. On financing, DOE LPO continues Palisades restart disbursements (~$491M to date) with $12.5B of advanced-nuclear loan authority open. Source: DOE — 202(c) · DOE — Palisades

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The Read — what it means for LRP

1. **The premium is migrating from "has an interconnect" to "is curtailable and self-powered."** Batch Zero, the 75 MW+ mandatory-curtailment rule, and Abbott's full-funding directive all reward the Google/Intersect Meitner template (generation-paired, flexible) and penalize speculative grid-only requests. The 438 GW queue will shrink hard as fees and security forfeiture bite — underwrite to the firmer ~226 GW reality, not the headline.
2. **West Texas land theses cut both ways.** The same flexibility/BYO-gen regime that favors Permian behind-the-meter plays (GW Ranch, Fermi, Pacifico) also imports the SB6 cost-allocation and curtailment overhang onto any grid-tied load. Hood County shows the live downside: Pacifico is litigating a Texas county over a revoked concept plan. Local control (or its absence) is now a priced siting risk.
3. **The capital window is open but repricing.** IG money will fund Texas data-center assets (Hut 8/Nueces), but neocloud credit prints near 9.6% and the GPU residual-value debate is sharpening the ABS math. Counterparty quality up the stack (Oracle CDS, SoftBank's OpenAI-collateral problem) remains the transmission cable — consistent with the Stargate-Abilene finding that the asset is sound and the offtake chain is where the risk lives.
4. **Two federal shoes drop within two weeks.** The FERC RM26-4 order (end of June) and the restored 5% safe harbor into the July 4 cliff will move the solar/storage and co-location economics that sit underneath nearly every Texas large-load deal. Position now; both are calendar-certain catalysts, not speculation.

On the Calendar

Date	Event
Jun 18	PUC open meeting — Batch Zero approval expected; FERC June open meeting
late Jun	FERC RM26-4 large-load order committed
Jun 21 / 28	DOE 202(c) emergency orders expire (IN / CO)
Jul 4	OBBBA begin-construction cliff (wind/solar 45Y/48E); DOE Reactor Pilot ≥3-criticality goal
Jul 10	Batch Zero target effective date
Jul 17	PUC + ERCOT joint memo to Governor (data-center cost protections)
Jul 31	PUC must initiate action to cut residential transmission costs
~Jul	Texas TANEO first advanced-nuclear grant awards
by Dec 31	SB6 §25.194 adoption deadline; last day for TEF In-ERCOT initial disbursements

Grid Wire · Land Resource Partners · Compiled June 15, 2026; updated 22:53 UTC same day (Nvidia $25B bond; June-15 nuclear-equity move). Methodology: five-lane fan-out research (ERCOT/market, data centers, AI-infra financing, advanced nuclear, policy), every item date-checked against a primary or first-tier source. Items that failed verification — e.g. recycled 2018/2023 ERCOT summer-heat coverage, 2025-vintage nuclear deals re-tagged "June 2026," and out-of-window data-center ABS — were excluded. Not investment advice; internal and peer circulation.